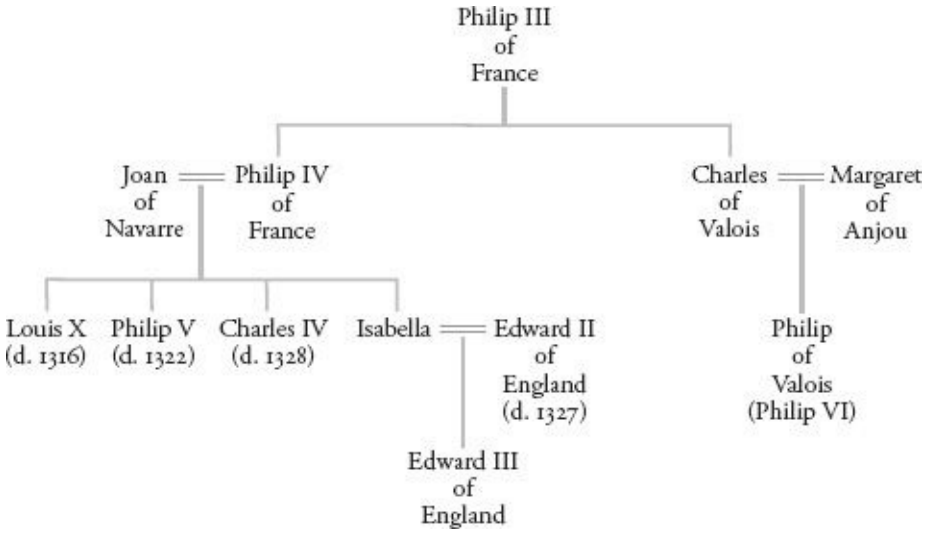


66.1 Genealogy of Philip VI and Edward III.

The following year, the new Philip VI of France summoned Edward III to come and do homage for the county of Guienne. Isabella decided that it would be politic for her son to agree, and so the seventeen-year-old king of England meekly walked through the ritual of submission and loyalty: placing his hands underneath the hands of the French king, promising to remain his liege man. But the obeisance was Edward's last act of obedience. He was nearly of age, and fed up with his regents. "The King began to grow in body and mind," Gray notes, "which was not agreeable to the authority of the Queen his mother."[18]

In the following year, 1330, the young king turned eighteen. Immediately he dissolved the regency, in the most direct way possible: he sent two of his younger friends with a party of soldiers to arrest Mortimer and his mother in the middle of the night.

Mortimer suffered the same fate as Hugh Despenser. After a quick trial, he was drawn and quartered, "upon a charge of having been party to the death of the King, Edward II." Isabella was placed under polite house arrest; her son provided her with comfortable rooms, an income, and ladies in waiting, but ordered her never to go out or show herself in public again.[19]